Netanyahu declared that the “flags march” will take place in Jerusalem on Thursday, May 18, as usual. Ben-Gvir will participate. Every year, it is an occasion for trouble. There is no doubt that Israeli society is moving to the right—not to the extreme-right, but to the right. Probably not beyond what the US would allow, but, let’s say, to a moderate Republican right. If Biden wins next year, Netanyahu will have to accommodate him, but if the Republicans win …

I have seen the whole cycle: it’s not that the socialist phase was a period to remember, except, as far as I am concerned, in the case of parties like Mapam and particularly Meretz, which were more interested in finding some arrangement with the Palestinians than in any other left-wing goal. Yossi Sarid and Shulamit Aloni were my preferred politicians, but their influence was minimal. The left of the 1960s and the 1970s was infinitely preferable to today’s right. Today’s right has to be fought by all legal means. I hope that the demonstrations will start again, in strength.

Tuesday, May 16

The budget as it is currently planned, with all its perks for the ultra-Orthodox and additions for the settlers, will seriously slow economic growth and lower the standard of living of a majority of Israelis. That factor may help the protests.

You may not know our ultra-Orthodox method of negotiating: now that they have received enormous perks, they are suddenly asking for 627 million shekels more. Either they will receive it or some substantial equivalent. And they didn’t forget anything, either: where is the law exempting the yeshiva students from military service? It should be voted now, even before the budget! How will our Houdini get out of that?

A worrying report about antisemitism in Europe. Apparently, some 38 percent of European Jews are considering emigrating. I do not know